

Title

Protocol for Timing of Delivery in Pregnancy-Related Hypertension: A Randomised Comparison of Maternal Experience Outcomes

Abstract

This prospective trial aims to evaluate maternal birth experiences in women diagnosed with hypertension during or prior to pregnancy. Participants will be allocated via randomisation to either elective delivery at 38 to 39 weeks gestation or continuation with routine antenatal monitoring until spontaneous labour onset or term. The primary comparison will examine subjective measures of childbirth satisfaction across four validated domains: personal agency during labour, quality of clinical support, sense of safety, and level of involvement in decision-making. Secondary assessments will explore free-text reflections from mothers and document any maternal or neonatal complications. The trial will recruit from 42 maternity centres across the United Kingdom and aims to enrol approximately 400 women. All participants will complete questionnaires postpartum, with qualitative data analysed thematically. This design will provide evidence on whether timing modification alters perceived birth experience in this high-risk obstetric population.